

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption and Transformation Leader | Fifteen Years in Regulated Financial Services

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. I spent fifteen years inside a Fortune 100 financial services firm getting people to change how they work when none of them reported to me, in a business where Risk, Compliance, and Legal could stop anything I built. At TIAA (\$1.5T AUM) I conceived an AI-powered career development platform, led the team that built it, and owned it from use-case scoping through governance, rollout, and measurement. I then carried one adoption operating model across a portfolio of business areas I did not control. I also conceived and shipped two agentic AI products that are live in production, so I know the distance between an AI idea and something people actually use. I am not the engineer, and the things I have shipped are the reason I do not need to be.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist, internal Lean Consultant (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

AI From Concept to Enterprise-Scale Adoption

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, governance, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it and I reached 1,500+ directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching, because you cannot send an email and call it adoption.
- **One adoption operating model across seven business areas, none of whose leaders reported to me.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own use cases. I set the operating rhythm and the prioritization. The design was never the hard part. Getting seven leaders to give up their own version of the work was.
- **Built with the tools rather than only sponsoring them.** I built the platform's manager guide using Amazon Q Developer in one week, so the people asked to lead the change had something usable in front of them that week.
- **Reported results in numbers an executive could act on.** I defined the success measures, tracked them, and carried them to senior leaders through executive read-outs, business cases, and quarterly business reviews. Adoption was measured by active usage, never by headcount with access. I built and negotiated a \$300K annual Client Services engagement budget with Finance inside roughly \$500K of Client Services program spend I administered, then showed what it bought.

Risk Governance Inside a Regulated Firm

- **Set the hard limits, in that order.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision. Governance was a design input rather than a gate at the end.
- **Found the permission exposure the AI work was sitting on.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT. An assistant surfaces to a person everything they already have permission to reach, so permission sprawl is a day-one exposure rather than a later phase.

- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. That was not an AI purchase and I do not present it as one. The evaluation discipline transfers.

Change People Did Not Choose

- **700 people absorbed a smaller building without a retention crisis.** Corporate Real Estate set the target and I directed the execution, moving 700 associates from assigned seating into a hoteling model and giving back five floors, roughly 44 percent of the square footage, while the work kept running. The number was the plan. Getting people to live inside it afterward was the job. I then managed the Frisco Corporate Center transition for 500+ Client Services associates.
- **Built the workforce capability program for a transformation population.** I conceived Skills of the Future and led a team of 7 to build 5 curriculum tracks of 12 to 17 modules each for the associates affected by the Recordkeeping Transformation, reaching 890 unique users and 1,156 community views.

AGENTIC AI I CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily, not a demo.** Each agent holds a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates have caught overclaims on their way into live work. They have also missed one. I published the methodology behind this practice in 2026.
- **Two live products.** CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), where I conceived the journey, a four-agent AI interview simulator, and an applicant CRM, and directed the build. Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), where I designed the 5-stage framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made them real.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **Sat on the sales side of enterprise talent-technology deals for financial services clients.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions. I was the engineer on the sales team rather than the closer, scoping capability needs and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Bank of America, GE Capital, Royal Bank of Canada, Regions Bank, Unilever, and Verizon Wireless. I facilitated the working sessions internationally, traveling for them often. I know what enterprise buyers of this software actually pay for, because I was across the table from them.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI Strategy and Acceleration: Enterprise AI Roadmap | Use-Case Intake, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Adoption KPIs and Value Realization | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | AI Fluency and Capability Building | Business Process Redesign | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer

Governance and Risk Partnership: Responsible AI Governance and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Data Privacy Remediation | Vendor Evaluation and RFP Scoring | Organizational Change Management

Enterprise and Executive: Executive Read-Outs, Business Cases and Quarterly Business Reviews | Client Services Budget Built and Negotiated (\$300K) | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | Regulated Financial Services (ERISA, SEC) | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA
Generative AI Leader Certification, Google (2026) | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class) | Leadership Skills, The Institute for Management Studies (2025)